

Hana Awad

User Experience Designer & ex-Architect

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Passionate interface and UX designer with front-end development experience and an architect's background. I take products from research and information architecture through to designed, shipped interfaces — and, because I also write front-end code, I design with the grain of what's buildable. Ex-architect from Alexandria, Egypt, now based in Copenhagen.

STRENGTHS & WORKING STYLE

-  **Hard worker** — I take ownership from first research to shipped product, and I follow through.
-  **Love to negotiate** — I enjoy finding the middle ground between user needs, business goals, and engineering constraints to reach decisions the team can commit to.
-  **Problem solver** — I like untangling messy, ambiguous problems and turning them into clear, buildable solutions.
-  **Always curious** — I love learning how things work, and I pick up new tools, domains, and codebases quickly.
-  **Architect's eye** — A background in structure, proportion, and detail that shapes how I approach UX and information.

EXPERIENCE

- **Senior UX Designer Lead** Apr 2021 – Present
SOUNDBOKS · Copenhagen, Denmark
 - Translate insights and business requirements into product design concepts and intuitive end-to-end experiences.
 - Lead UX design strategy from start to finish — deep research, creative ideation, and tackling design-strategy and information-architecture challenges across the whole UX journey.
 - Develop user-centric brand experiences across online shops, digital products, and services; build customer journeys, sketches and wireframes.
 - Lead research projects and develop new app features through cross-team collaboration with stakeholders across departments.
 - Build a Figma component library and design frameworks for website and mobile app, improving UI consistency and speed of delivery.
 - Work with scalable, responsive designs; collaborate with Product Owners and Engineers from conception to launch in an agile, weekly-sprint process.
- **UX Designer & Frontend Developer** Aug 2018 – Present
Ovni · Egypt
 - Developed user personas and user journeys, and defined the product roadmap and KPIs to prioritise work.
 - Fast sketching and prototyping; designed website and mobile-app frameworks in Figma for back-end developers.
 - Implemented designs using the Angular framework, working weekly with back-end developers on the high-level experience and key interactions.
 - Worked with the marketing team to understand market traction and strengthen community building.

- UX Designer & Frontend Developer** Sep 2019 – Aug 2020
 Memorix · Copenhagen, Denmark
 - Weekly user testing plus desk and on-site research to understand user challenges and the market domain.
 - Developed personas and journeys; defined the product roadmap and KPIs.
 - Designed website and mobile-app frameworks in Figma and implemented designs using Angular, working daily with back-end developers.
- Frontend Web Developer Intern** Jul 2019 – Sep 2019
 Valuer · Copenhagen, Denmark
 - Redesigned proposals for Valuer's website; produced e-book and thumbnail designs.
- Full-Stack & Web Developer Intern** Mar 2019 – Sep 2019
 Bomae · Copenhagen, Denmark
 - Built a customised CRM to meet business requirements, giving full visibility on cases and easier document sharing with customers.
 - Designed and implemented the dashboard, improving employee productivity.
- Interior Designer (Freelance)** Jul 2016 – Sep 2018
 Freelance · Egypt · Zurich · Copenhagen
 - Delivered residential apartment, villa and office projects — client consultation, schematic design, 3D visualisation, detailed drawings and final delivery.
- Architect, Researcher & Teaching Assistant** Jul 2014 – Sep 2018
 Arab Academy for Science & Technology (AAST) · Alexandria, Egypt
 - Organised and developed teaching material for university lectures; reviewed material with students in group and one-to-one sessions.
 - Assisted in preparing examinations and grading student progress and projects.

EDUCATION

- MSc, Architectural Engineering & Environmental Design** Sep 2017 – Aug 2019
 Arab Academy for Science & Technology (AAST) · Alexandria, Egypt
 Graduated with honours. Thesis: a sustainable-design approach studying natural ventilation in educational buildings.
- BSc, Architectural Engineering & Environmental Design** Sep 2009 – Aug 2014
 Arab Academy for Science & Technology (AAST) · Alexandria, Egypt
- Front-End Web Development Nanodegree** Jan 2020
 Udacity · Online
- Web Development Bootcamp** Jan 2019
 Le Wagon · Copenhagen, Denmark
 9-week full-stack bootcamp: Ruby, Ruby on Rails, JavaScript, HTML & CSS, APIs, GitHub, Heroku — plus an introduction to UX design and Figma.
- Parametric Design Course** Sep 2014
 Architectural Association · Berlin, Germany
- Sustainability Summer School** Jul 2011
 University of Lincoln · Lincoln, UK

CERTIFICATIONS

LinkedIn Learning · Jan 2021

Analyzing User Data

Creating Personas

Ideation

Creating Scenarios & Storyboards

Implementation Planning

Prototyping

Multidevice Design

SKILLS

UX / UI

Figma

Adobe XD

InVision

Whimsical

Sketching

Wireframing

Prototyping

Usability testing

Photoshop

Illustrator

InDesign

Front-end & software

HTML

CSS

JavaScript

Angular

Bootstrap

Ruby

Ruby on Rails

Git

Heroku

Linux

OOP

SaaS

Architecture

Autodesk Revit 2D/3D

Autodesk 3D-MAX

SketchUp

AutoCAD

3D visualisation & rendering

Schematic design

Technical drawing

Design research

Project planning

Parametric design

Sustainable design

Spatial & systems thinking

Ways of working

Agile / Scrum

Information architecture

Customer journeys

Cross-team collaboration

LANGUAGES

Arabic

Native

English

Fluent

Danish

Learning (module 3)

French

Beginner